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Examining the Future Trajectory of Entrepreneurship

by Donald F. Kuratko and Michael H. Morris

Consistent with the theme of this special issue, entrepreneurship today is truly everywhere—across campuses, across communities, and across borders. However, we know that entrepreneurship is being defined in different ways . . . by different audiences! Exactly how entrepreneurship gets redefined and by whom is the major challenge confronting the discipline as that will forge the future trajectory for everyone. In order to avoid the tendencies to apply entrepreneurship in virtually any context no matter how far removed it is from the act of recognizing and capitalizing on opportunity for the purposes of economic or social gain, this paper examines six major trajectories that will significantly influence the future of this discipline.

You can't solve a problem on the same level that it was created. You have to rise above it to the next level.

—Albert Einstein

Introduction

Consistent with the theme of this special issue, entrepreneurship today is truly everywhere. . . across campuses, across communities, and across borders. With the dramatic advances in entrepreneurship scholarship, academic programs, and pedagogy over the past 40 years, there is no question the discipline has achieved academic legitimacy. More importantly, as the theme indicates, entrepreneurship has moved beyond business schools to achieve relevance and impact in a wide range of arenas.

Morris, Kuratko, and Cornwall (2013) recently noted, “A new wave of economic development is sweeping the world, with entrepreneurship and innovation as the primary catalysts. Yet the

entrepreneurial imperative involves much more than encouraging people to start new ventures. Rather, it encourages a mindset that centers on seeking opportunities, taking risks beyond security, tolerating failure, bootstrapping, creatively leveraging resources, and having the tenacity to overcome obstacles and push an idea to implementation” (p. x). It is about creating new opportunities and executing new concepts in uncertain and unknowable environments (Neck and Greene 2011). As a mindset, entrepreneurship has assumed a unique position globally because of its empowering and transformational potential. Thus, it is permeating a wide range of demographic, ethnic, organizational, institutional, socio-economic, geographic, cultural, and political boundaries.

“Entrepreneurship and entrepreneurship education have more relevance today than ever before” (Neck and Greene 2011, p. 55). Yet with this unprecedented growth and development of a modern discipline comes the question of where the future trajectory of entrepreneurship education is heading. Continued success for this discipline is dependent on examining

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this question and working to shape the trajectory of entrepreneurship before it is shaped for us.

As the *Journal of Business Venturing* celebrated its 30th anniversary in 2015, Editor-in-Chief Dean Shepherd (2015) wrote a special editorial in which he states that “a discussion of entrepreneurship is timely because now that the field of entrepreneurship has achieved legitimacy, it faces both opportunities and threats. It is thus timely to acknowledge the threats and think about opportunities to advance the field” (p. 489). He further explains that the purpose of his editorial is “to highlight potential sources of vitality for its future. This vitality will likely continually change the boundaries of what is labeled as entrepreneurship” (p. 489).

What we may face, then, is a continuing redefinition of entrepreneurship, which in itself can be positive. However, we know that entrepreneurship is being defined *in different ways ... by different audiences!* Exactly how entrepreneurship gets redefined and by whom is the major challenge confronting the discipline as that will forge the future trajectory for everyone. As we examine this pressing question, a brief review of the past evolution of entrepreneurship education is important.

A Journey That Started from Nowhere

The field of entrepreneurship education has evolved over the last 40 years from something considered to be little more than an applied trade to a respected area of academic study. There was no “research” to be accomplished because it was thought that those who could not attend college would simply “practice” the concept of new business start-up (Bull and Willard 1993). The earliest academic journal in this field started in 1963 the *Journal of Small Business Management*. The early articles were more practice oriented (to fit the times), and it was not until 1976 that the *American Journal of Small Business* was founded. It was later renamed *Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice* in 1988 when the journal moved from the University of Baltimore to Baylor University with founding editor D. Ray Bagby. The next generation of entrepreneurship journals that emerged and their years of founding are the *Journal of Business Venturing* (1985), *Family Business Review* (1988), *Small Business Economics* (1989), *Entrepreneurship and Regional*

Development (1989), and *Small Business Strategy* (1990). Today, entrepreneurship research is also published in top management journals such as *Administrative Science Quarterly*, *Strategic Management Journal*, *Academy of Management Review*, *Academy of Management Journal*, *Journal of Management*, *Journal of Operations Management*, and *Journal of Management Studies*.

In his review of the chronology of entrepreneurship education, Katz (2003) included economic and agricultural literatures and experiences dating back to 1876, while others have touted the Harvard courses taught in 1947. However, the reality of entrepreneurship education as a force in business schools began in the early 1970s. The University of Southern California launched the first MBA concentration in entrepreneurship in 1971 followed by the first undergraduate concentration in 1972. Babson College initiated their emphasis on entrepreneurship in 1975 and the field of entrepreneurship education began to emerge. While only a handful of schools were teaching entrepreneurship in the early 1980s, the field began a dynamic growth spurt in the late 1980s and 1990s. This take-off occurred as the interest shifted from teaching small business management to the conceptualization and launch of scalable, high-potential ventures predicated on new technologies and innovative business ideas.

Entrepreneurship education has been the subject of numerous studies over the past thirty years (e.g., Brush et al. 2003; Dickson, Solomon, and Weaver 2008; Gartner and Vesper 1994; Katz 2003, 2004, 2008; Kuratko 2005; Neck and Greene 2011; Solomon 2007; Solomon, Duffy, and Tarabishy 2002; Solomon and Fernald 1991; Solomon, Weaver, and Fernald 1994; Vesper and Gartner 1997, 1999). While identifying a variety of obstacles and challenges that had to be overcome, these studies document a remarkable rate of growth and development in the curricula and related campus-based programs devoted to entrepreneurship and new venture creation. From single digits in the 1970s, the number of colleges and universities across the globe offering entrepreneurship-related courses is now well over three thousand (Kuratko 2017). The typical curriculum has expanded from one or two offerings to as many as 40 or more distinct courses. Large numbers of universities now offer majors, minors, concentrations, certificates, and master's degrees in entrepreneurship. Some of the more prestigious research

universities have developed Ph.D. programs to prepare the next generation of entrepreneurship scholars (Morris, Kuratko, and Cornwall 2013).

Over these past four decades, entrepreneurship has grown within universities faster than virtually any other area of intellectual pursuit. And it appears that the pace is accelerating, with more universities seeking to develop programs and centers focused on entrepreneurship. Importantly, these efforts have begun to extend beyond their traditional base within business schools and to reach faculty, students, and administrators across the university campus. The current trend in most universities is to develop or expand entrepreneurship programs and design unique and challenging curricula specifically designed for entrepreneurship students. Kuratko (2005) notes, "Entrepreneurship is new and it is about continual innovation and creativity. It is the future of business schools and it should begin to move into a leadership role" (p. 591).

The growth of recognition with entrepreneurship programs is another example of the evolution that has taken place. Top entrepreneurial schools are honored each year by the United States Association for Small Business and Entrepreneurship and the Global Consortium of Entrepreneurship Centers. In addition, national recognition has also emerged through some of the top rankings of universities with entrepreneurship programs done by the *Financial Times*, *U.S. News & World Report*, and *Fortune* magazine.

With the evolution of the field, a number of specialty areas have emerged. Building on Kuratko, Morris, and Schindehutte (2015), as well as a comprehensive review of the literature, we provide below ten of the major themes that characterize recent research about entrepreneurs and new-venture creation and are increasingly reflected in entrepreneurship education:

- *Opportunities and the entrepreneurial process*, how opportunities are uncovered and exploited through an emergent process and interdependent set of activities (Bygrave 1989; McMullen and Dimov 2013; Moroz and Hindle 2012; Shane 2000; Short et al. 2009).
- *Venture financing*, including both venture capital and angel capital financing as well as other innovative financing techniques (Busenitz, Fiet, and Moesel 2004; Dimov, Shepherd, and Sutcliffe 2007).
- *Entrepreneurial cognition*, the knowledge structures used to make assessments involving opportunity evaluation, venture creation, and growth (Grégoire, Corbett, and McMullen 2011; Haynie et al. 2010; Haynie, Shepherd, and Patzelt 2012).
- *Economic development and entrepreneurship*, the nature and role of entrepreneurial activity as a driving force in creating jobs, income, wealth, economic growth, and societal quality of life, including the base of the pyramid (Acs and Varga 2005; Audretsch 2009; Audretsch, Keilbach, and Lehmann 2006; Morris, Neumeyer, and Kuratko 2015; Wennekers et al. 2005).
- *Family business*, economic and social contributions of entrepreneurs with family businesses as well as challenges they face (Chrisman, Chua, and Steier 2011; Morris et al. 2010).
- *Corporate entrepreneurship*, innovative actions within large organizations and the need for entrepreneurial cultures (Ireland, Covin, and Kuratko 2009; Kuratko, Hornsby, and Hayton 2015; Morris, Kuratko, and Covin 2011).
- *Social entrepreneurship and sustainability*, applying traditional (private-sector) entrepreneurship activities for transformational social problem solving (Dean and McMullen 2007; Parrish 2010; Shepherd and Patzelt 2011).
- *Women and minority entrepreneurship*, examining the obstacles and difficulties different from those that other entrepreneurs face (de Bruin, Brush, and Welter 2006; DeTienne and Chandler 2007; Robb and Watson 2012).
- *Global entrepreneurship*, the global focus of entrepreneurial firms and the challenges of fostering entrepreneurial activity around the world (Autio, George, and Alexy 2011; Coviello, McDougall, and Oviatt 2011; Jones, Coviello, and Tang 2011).
- *Entrepreneurship research, education and pedagogy*, from business and engineering schools to entire campus programs in entrepreneurship this has become an important movement in universities (Kuratko 2005; Morris, Kuratko, and Cornwall 2013; Neck and Greene 2011).

The impressive development of entrepreneurship is attributable to a number of pioneers (scholars, educators, editors, and others) who

demonstrated courage, passion, and imagination in forging what today is a unique discipline with increasingly strong theoretical foundations, an array of useful conceptual frameworks and tools, complex empirical insights, rich content, and evolving boundaries. It is a discipline where a solid beachhead has been established in terms of the big questions that we face and how much there is to learn regarding the nature of entrepreneurial activity. And it is a discipline that each year is influencing how hundreds of thousands of students see themselves and the entrepreneurial possibilities that can transform their lives and the world around them.

Challenges of Entrepreneurship Everywhere: Where to from Here?

As the depth and breadth of the discipline continue to expand, what are the implications for the future of entrepreneurship education? It is fair to conclude that the development of entrepreneurship in higher education, while breathtaking, has been chaotic and disjointed. Courses and degree programs have often been added in what may seem a happenstance manner, rarely guided by any sort of curricular model or cogent strategy, and often with considerable overlap among offerings. New structures have emerged that include academic departments of entrepreneurship often with unclear missions and objectives. New tools and techniques are promulgated and become popularized, such as the lean start-up and the business model canvas, with little understanding of their shortcomings or the contexts in which they can be more, or less, effective. Many of those who teach entrepreneurship are not versed in the core content of the discipline, and may never have studied entrepreneurship or taken an entrepreneurship course. While entrepreneurship education is now reaching across the campus, what happens when it has no moorings in a business school? The failure of many of the campus-wide programs funded by sizable grants from the Kauffman Foundation just a few years ago makes clear that it matters who is involved in these programs.

Where do we go from here? How do we ensure the progress to date is not undone? On the one hand, we must continue to develop a unique identity for the field of entrepreneurship,

such that it is not simply subsumed by other disciplines. At the same time, we must avoid the tendencies to apply entrepreneurship in virtually any context no matter how far removed it is from the act of recognizing and capitalizing on opportunity for the purposes of economic or social gain; or to label literally any phenomenon as being “entrepreneurial” simply because it is different from the status quo. The way forward requires a reassessment of some of the most basic issues surrounding, and perhaps the very essence of, entrepreneurship education. Toward this end, let us consider six trajectories.

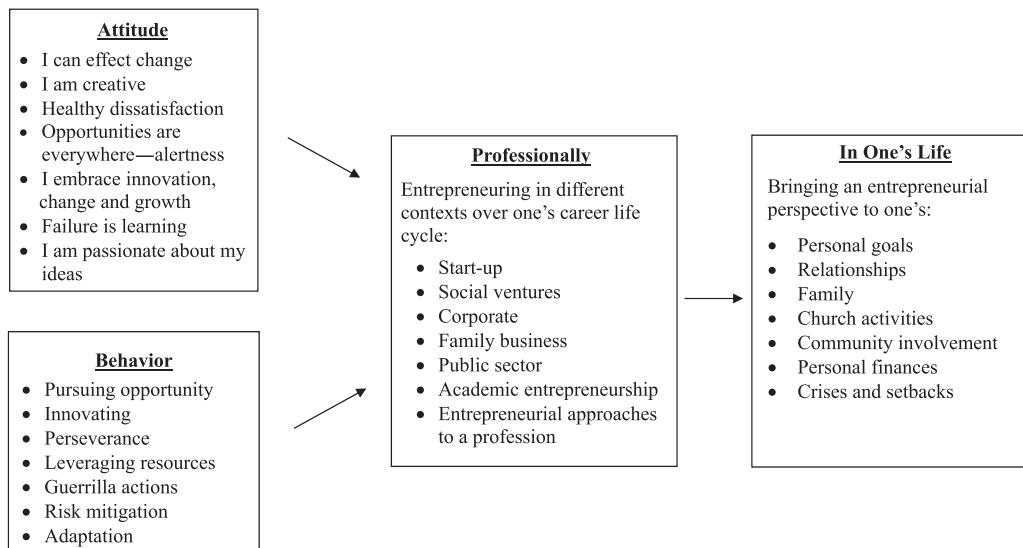
Trajectory 1: Why Teach Entrepreneurship—A Clear Purpose

What is the purpose of entrepreneurship education? Perhaps a beginning point in determining purpose is to define the term. This is actually a problem at many institutions, as different faculty members employ differing definitions—in effect prioritizing particular foci such as innovation, opportunity exploitation, or venture creation. Building on a shared conceptualization can establish a clear purpose for the effort, enhance communication and collaboration across disciplines, and reduce any confusion experienced by different stakeholders. For instance, a definition that centers on “*a process of creating value through unique resource combinations for the purpose of capitalizing on opportunity*” (Stevenson, Roberts, and Grousbek 1992) or “*a dynamic process of vision, change, and creation, requiring an application of energy and passion toward the creation and implementation of innovative ideas and creative solutions*” (Kuratko 2017) provides direction, yet can be applied in virtually any discipline and to a wide range of innovative activities and contexts.

It is likely that the purpose of entrepreneurship education varies depending on the institutional context within which it is taught. Some examples include:

- Teach students the principles and tools necessary to start a successful business
- Fill a gap in the business school curriculum by addressing start-up and small business contexts
- Advance our knowledge and understanding of entrepreneurial behavior
- Foster entrepreneurial activity and economic development in the community

Figure 1
A Framework for Teaching the Entrepreneurial Mindset



- Play a contributing role to the spread of entrepreneurship across a campus, the development of entrepreneurial ecosystems within a university, and/or the emergence of an entrepreneurial university

Beyond this, institutions may seek to satisfy generous donors who themselves have successfully started ventures. A more pedestrian purpose might simply be to remain competitive by keeping up with what other schools are doing.

It is our conviction that the future will find all of these aspirations will continue to guide entrepreneurial education in differing degrees, but that the underlying purpose will increasingly center on conveying and developing the entrepreneurial mindset among different stakeholder groups. Many schools now focus on courses in creativity and design thinking, which are important elements in the eventual development of ventures. However, without the entrepreneurial component woven into these programs, they lack the true perspective of the entrepreneurial mindset. But what exactly is the entrepreneurial mindset? McGrath and Macmillan (2000) stress an ongoing focus on recognizing opportunities and pursuing the most attractive ones with passion and discipline while leveraging the resources of those around them.

Ireland, Hitt, and Sirmon (2003) emphasize the ability to rapidly sense opportunity, act on it, and mobilize resources, even under uncertain conditions. In Figure 1, we propose a conceptualization of the entrepreneurial mindset that approaches it as a way of both thinking (Haynie et al. 2010) and acting (McGrath and MacMillan 2000). Hence it includes attitudinal and behavioral components.

The question is whether this mindset can actually be taught. We believe that it can be developed and reinforced within students. How this is done brings us to our next trajectory, the content of entrepreneurship education.

Trajectory 2: What Is Taught in Entrepreneurship—The Content

The purpose of an educational program drives what is taught. The core entrepreneurship curriculum at an institution provides the common knowledge for all students coming out of the program. For many programs, the core curriculum not only serves undergraduate and graduate students pursuing formal degree programs in entrepreneurship (e.g., majors, minors, concentrations, specialties) but also those from across campus interested in getting some exposure to the discipline. Its design is a reflection of how those at an institution conceptualize

Table 1
Categorizing the Content of Entrepreneurship Education

Business Basics	Entrepreneurship Basics	Entrepreneurial Mindset
Setting up the books	Entrepreneurship defined	Opportunity alertness
How to sell	The entrepreneurial process	Risk mitigation
Hiring of staff	Characteristics of entrepreneurs	Resource leveraging
Forms of enterprise	Types of entrepreneurs	Conveying a vision
Cash flow management	Contexts for entrepreneurship	Value innovation
Formulating strategy	Innovative business models	Passion
Market analysis	Entrepreneurial cognition	Persistence and tenacity
Setting up operations	The nature of opportunity	Creative problem-solving
Pricing	Ethics and entrepreneurship	Guerrilla behavior
Promotion and advertising	Seed and venture capital	Optimism
Financial statements	Lean start up	Learning from failure
Franchising	Entrepreneurial orientation	Effecting change
Management control	Effectuation	Adaptation
Cost analysis	Exit strategies	Resilience
Protecting IP	Entrepreneurship and the economy	

entrepreneurship, the relative importance they place on the discipline, and their priorities in terms of critical topical areas.

If we consider the content of modern entrepreneurship program, it would seem the emphasis might take three forms, or more typically, some combination of these forms: (1) business basics in a new venture management context; (2) core entrepreneurial content; and (3) the entrepreneurial mindset. Table 1 provides examples of what is or might be taught in each of these three areas. Our concern is that the items in the first column of Table 1 tend to dominate the content of many entrepreneurship programs, particularly when they are taught by individuals without much exposure to the academic discipline of entrepreneurship. Yet it could be argued that much of what we have under business basics could be taught by existing units within a business school, and eliminates the need for an entrepreneurship faculty. From a future trajectory vantage point, much more attention is needed in developing and delivering core entrepreneurship content, and, most importantly, content that relates to the entrepreneurial mindset. For this reason, we argue that competency-centered approaches to the design of what is taught in entrepreneurship will become paramount.

Morris, Kuratko, and Cornwall (2013) have empirically generated a set of thirteen core

entrepreneurial competencies (as opposed to conventional managerial competencies) based on a multistage methodology involving successful entrepreneurs and leading academics. These competencies are consistent with the elements associated with the entrepreneurial mindset in Figure 1. Such competencies become the raw material used in designing the curriculum, co-curricular programing, and degree programs. We shall return to these competencies in our discussion of outcomes of teaching, below.

Because of the idiosyncratic ways in which many entrepreneurship programs develop, they historically have lacked a model or framework around which to design the curriculum—something less likely to be the case as we look to the future. A well-designed curricular model delineates a core knowledge base in entrepreneurship (e.g., definitions, concepts, frameworks, principles), distinguishes common offerings for any student versus disciplinary-distinct courses, establishes a coherent mix of different contexts for entrepreneurship, and provides a well-defined set of entrepreneurial competencies and facilitators of entrepreneurial activity that can be applied within any discipline. As noted in Figure 1, entrepreneurship can happen in virtually any context—new start-ups, small businesses, family businesses, franchises, corporate entrepreneurship, and social ventures all represent distinct areas of study. Other contexts include entrepreneurship

Table 2
Two General Categories of Experiential Learning Opportunities

Course-Based	Co-Curricular
Idea diaries	Idea jams
Business models	Internships at entrepreneurial ventures and incubators
Business plans	Entrepreneurial mentors
Feasibility studies	Entrepreneurship study abroad
Written or video case studies	Elevator pitch competitions
Case studies	Campus business plan competitions
Live cases	Student venture hatcheries
Interviews of entrepreneurs	Campus-based businesses run by students
Hollywood movies	Prototype development
Entrepreneurial audits	Website development
Marketing inventions	Start-up weekends
Small business consulting projects	Students competing in regional/national competitions
In-class games/exercises	Shadowing entrepreneurs
Simulations	Student Venture Fairs
Adopt a family firm	Speaker series
Role plays	Community outreach initiatives (bootcamps, symposia)
Guest lectures by entrepreneurs	Technology commercialization projects

within particular professions or disciplines, such as entrepreneurship and the arts, agricultural entrepreneurship, health care entrepreneurship, or engineering and entrepreneurship.

The systematic integration of entrepreneurship into different disciplines on a given campus, whether for teaching purposes, as part of a research initiative, or in the form of a service or community engagement project, should have mechanisms in place to document and share best practices and common mistakes among those in the various disciplines participating in university-wide entrepreneurship.

Trajectory 3: How Entrepreneurship Is Taught—The Delivery Mechanism

Entrepreneurship content is delivered through conventional lectures, flipped classrooms, online platforms, and through various other vehicles. But the key to how the content is taught in the coming years lies in how educators make the learning process experiential. Experiential learning, or what Neck, Greene, and Brush (2014) term “deliberate practice,” can take a wide variety of forms. An important distinction concerns the percentage of experiential learning that entrepreneurship faculty want to occur within a course versus outside of specific courses, or through so-called co-curricular

programming. Table 2 provides examples of the kinds of experiential learning initiatives built into entrepreneurship courses and ones associated with co-curricular learning. We believe the balance will increasingly shift in the direction of (1) as much as half of what is learned through coursework occurring experientially; (2) more than half a student’s total learning tied to co-curricular programming.

A more strategic approach to experiential learning will find entrepreneurship program directors making available portfolios of experiences that reflect the different learning styles of students. For instance, Schindehutte (2013) has built on the experiential learning theory of Kolb (2015) to suggest that experiential learning activities be distinguished based on the extent to which they are more applied or theoretical, hands on or minds on, and require more active or reflective learning. Thus, using the learning styles of Kolb and Kolb (2005), having a student write a business plan falls into a quadrant that reflects students who learn better through “active experimentation,” while a guest lecture by an entrepreneur may be more impacting for a students who learns more through “reflective observation,” and having a venture in a student incubator works well for students who learn best through “concrete experience.”

For their part, students will increasingly be expected to build experience portfolios as they progress through their studies in entrepreneurship. Hence, on completion of a minor, major, certificate, or other program in entrepreneurship, the student might submit a portfolio summary that includes their work on idea diaries, elevator pitches, business models, small business consulting reports, interviews with entrepreneurs, entrepreneurial audits, study abroad experiences, and so forth.

Trajectory 4: Organizing Entrepreneurship—The Structure

The structures used to manage entrepreneurship programs dictate the needed resource model to sustain efforts over time. As Morris, Kuratko, and Cornwall (2013, pp. 20–21) explain, “While structure covers a wide range of organizational issues, the most fundamental include determining where the entrepreneurship program should be housed, how it will be led, to whom it will report, how it is staffed, and how it operates from a budgetary standpoint” (pp. 20–21).

Scholarly credibility is enhanced when a program chooses a structure within a unit that has academic standing, as opposed to one that is administrative in nature. Credibility is further affected by the extent to which those running the program have control over creation and management of degree programs and courses. Associated with structure is the manner in which the entrepreneurship program is led. Does the program have a terminally qualified, tenure track faculty member in a leadership position, a clinical faculty member, or an administrative staff member? Structural decisions also determine reporting relationships. A critical decision concerns whether to place the entrepreneurship program within or outside of the business school. A final element is the extent to which those involved with the program have budgetary control. The freedom to pursue sponsorships, endowments, operating gifts, and grants as well as the manner in which received monies are expended, and the extent to which monies remain within the program are impacted by the structural form.

Whether more centralized or decentralized, and whether based in the business school or elsewhere, the program needs a structural base with consistent leadership and authority. Morris, Kuratko, and Cornwall (2013) identified five major structures that are demonstrated across

campuses today. They include general entrepreneurship programs, entrepreneurship centers and institutes, departments of management and entrepreneurship, departments of entrepreneurship, and schools of entrepreneurship. Although most have been affiliated in some way to schools or colleges of business, each structure presents its own governance and resource issues. A major resource issue in most cross-campus initiatives is that because they are driven by an established entrepreneurship program/center/departments, and so on, there is no budget assigned for cross campus efforts. While a variety of potential funding sources exist at most universities, there is a need to develop an explicit funding model based on the structure selected. Selecting from among the five structures is a principle means of ensuring a structural base from which entrepreneurship can operate and ensure the sustainability of any cross-campus initiative. Additional oversight from a board of advisors consisting of administrators, faculty and outside stakeholders can also foster sustainability.

Trajectory 5: Outcomes of Teaching Entrepreneurship—The Metrics

Are entrepreneurship programs actually accomplishing anything? Evidence of success is unclear, in spite of the increasing amount of resources going to support these programs. One of the challenges in this regard is to arrive at appropriate performance metrics. From a teaching standpoint, the conventional academic unit is evaluated on a mix of criteria, ranging from numbers and characteristics of students enrolled courses to ratings from teaching evaluations and successful job placements for graduates. Certainly entrepreneurship programs rely on similar metrics, but they also receive pressure, particularly from donors, alumni, and some of the entrepreneurship program ranking services (e.g., *Princeton Review*) to concentrate of venture creation metrics. It gets us back to formulating the purpose of such programs. Focusing on how many students actually launch ventures, and/or how many of these ventures are still around in five years implies entrepreneurship programs primarily exist to foster start-ups. Even here, though, it may be more useful to track venture-related activities undertaken by students. Entrepreneurship is temporal, with opportunities and ventures emerging. Hence, tracking such variables as business models developed, business plans written, prototypes

developed, patents or IP protection applied for, customer surveys completed, seed money proposals made, and related activity-based metrics. This also reinforces the experiential nature of entrepreneurship education.

Yet if programs are attempting to prepare students for a life of entrepreneurship, and seeking to instill an entrepreneurial mindset, we believe the coming years will find more emphasis on competency mastery. Competencies address the question “What should a student get better at because they studied entrepreneurship?” Using competencies such as those identified by Morris, Kuratko, and Cornwall (2013), students can be assessed on a pre- and post-basis to determine improvement in their abilities to recognize opportunity or mitigate risks.

Further, as more priority is placed on cross-campus entrepreneurship, basic metrics might be extended to include numbers of students involved with elements of the university-wide effort within each college or discipline, interdisciplinary collaborations that result in publications, new courses, and course modules developed and implemented, measures of student and faculty innovations that are traceable to involvement in the program, and economic and social impacts of collaborative community engagement projects.

Trajectory 6: Leadership of Entrepreneurship Programs—Academic Entrepreneurs

The ability to have impact is tied to leadership. For us, this means an individual with academic stature, clear vision regarding how entrepreneurship can inform other disciplines, and a strong sense of how other disciplines inform entrepreneurial activity. Over the years, some have argued that only those who have actually created ventures as entrepreneurs should be teaching the subject. While actual practice is always valuable, it is often practice in a particular application of entrepreneurship in a particular context, suggesting it is a partial measure of one’s understanding of entrepreneurship as a discipline. The theoretical and conceptual foundations will always be critical (see Fiet 2001). It also does not indicate an understanding of pedagogy, teaching, and learning styles, and other elements critical for success in an academic setting. Ultimate program success requires a well-coordinated team, including clinical faculty with entrepreneurial backgrounds, but the nature of the academic culture suggests

a need for a respected champion who combines political skills and academic credibility with an entrepreneurial mindset. How an educator views himself or herself may be critical to the development of a champion. Conventional role definitions include such concepts as educator, scholar, student mentor, program developer, program administrator, and grant seeker. We contend that entrepreneurship programs realize their full potential when those who deliver them define themselves as *academic entrepreneurs*. Hence the entrepreneurial mindset one is trying to convey to students becomes ingrained in how faculty and staff approach the academic environment. An academic entrepreneur is one who seeks to continually:

- discover opportunity within the academic setting
- develop programmatic innovations to capitalize on these opportunities
- implement a constant stream of curricular, research, student engagement, and community outreach innovations
- take calculated risks in a university environment
- leverage resources from within and outside the university to support program development and sustainability
- bootstrap and act as a guerrilla to get new initiative implemented

As an academic entrepreneur, the faculty member serves as more than keen observer of a discipline or adroit conveyor of a knowledge base. He or she becomes as an agent of social and economic change, leveraging the university context to empower students and facilitate disruptive approaches to problem solving.

The Indispensable Trajectory: Empowerment and Transformation

Entrepreneurship programs can have a dramatic impact on university campuses, and some are currently doing so. The alternative path will find that legitimacy only motivates entrepreneurship units within colleges and universities to become more like existing academic units—that is, to become institutionalized. The key is that those who lead these programs continually apply the concept of entrepreneurial orientation

(EO) to their operations. Entrepreneurship scholars have developed a rich stream of research on EO and its implications for organizational performance (see e.g., Covin and Lumpkin 2011; Rauch et al. 2009). The question then becomes one of assessing how entrepreneurial are our entrepreneurship programs.

While generations of students arrive on campuses unprepared for an age when they must be more mobile, agile, innovative, resourceful, and adaptable, there is evidence that they are profoundly more interested in entrepreneurship than any previous generation (Koebler 2011). And why not? Entrepreneurs are the heroes—they make the world livable for everyone else. They are the ones who question, who challenge; they are the ones who take responsibility for change; they are what the human spirit is all about; they are the hope for a better life, for the end of poverty, for the destruction of discrimination; they are the quiet revolutionaries. Simply stated, entrepreneurship is the most empowering, the most democratic, the most freedom-creating, and most transforming phenomenon is the history of the human race (Morris 2013).

An effective entrepreneurship program can empower students to create their own job; create their own future; create their own wealth; create their own sense of pride and self-worth; create their own identity; create their own facilities and operations; create jobs for others; create their own contribution to the world; and create their own ability to give back. If a properly structured and developed entrepreneurship program can offer this type of empowering potential for students, the outcomes can be transformative. Students become empowered to transform markets, business practices, industries, individuals, families, communities, and economies. In whatever manner the transformations occur, entrepreneurship represents the potential for individuals to change the world. This is no small statement and, in fact, it reveals the intense power of the entrepreneurial mindset that university education can foster in today's younger generation.

Our argument, then, is that the development of properly structured and designed entrepreneurship programs that reflect the context of a particular university should be predicated not simply on helping students understand concepts, theories, frameworks, and tools for starting a business. Rather, the underlying purpose should be to empower and transform students,

while simultaneously empowering and transforming the campus and community.

Conclusions

The remarkable development of entrepreneurship as a disciplinary focus within universities over the past forty years leads one to wonder what the next forty years will bring. Currently we find that, consistent with the theme of this special issue, entrepreneurship today is truly everywhere. However, if it is everywhere then it may also be nowhere in the future. That is, it may be dispersed into other disciplines without the true appreciation for the foundations and theories that form this field. As mentioned earlier, the journey of entrepreneurship started from nowhere so why would we want to return to that point even inadvertently. We have to accept the challenge to build the proper entrepreneurial framework for our universities today so that the future holds even greater promise for entrepreneurship as an academic field.

Looking toward the future, one scenario finds entrepreneurship, having now achieved legitimization, maturing into a scholarly endeavor that strives to mimic its somewhat older counterparts in the business disciplines (e.g., finance, marketing) or its much older counterparts in the social sciences (e.g., psychology, sociology). Such maturing may bring with it a more conservative view which moves scholarly activity further from practice and away from engagement with the entrepreneurial context. A very different scenario is reflected in our six trajectories. It is one where entrepreneurship helps to lead the transformation of universities and redefine their role in society, a vision reflected in the six

The latter scenario begins with the recognition that entrepreneurship is not about the mechanics of how to start and grow a new business, or the art and science of opportunity discovery and exploitation. It is about empowerment and transformation, where students from across the campus are encouraged to dream big; are given the tools to make such dreams come true; are challenged to do things greater than themselves; and are allowed to fail. Moreover, in this scenario, entrepreneurship programs serve as catalysts for new ways of thinking and acting on the part of all the internal and external stakeholders involved with these programs. They continually introduce new

approaches to learning through engagement, to the generation of original knowledge regarding how entrepreneurial behavior is facilitated, to the development of alternative business models that ensure the sustainability of universities, and to the establishment of richer and more impacting ways to interact with the external community. It is a scenario that will be realized, in the final analysis, by faculty members who define themselves as academic entrepreneurs.

This is *The Entrepreneurial Imperative of the 21st Century* (Kuratko 2009), and each professor's goal should be to make a difference in the theory, the process, or the practice of entrepreneurship. In so doing the discipline of entrepreneurship can be:

- the model for interdisciplinary research and study
- at the forefront of scholarship in action
- a leader in pedagogical innovation
- the standard setter for experiential learning
- the model for community engagement
- the archetype for new approaches to fund raising and resource generation
- at the forefront of changes to staffing and reward systems

It is a discipline that can meaningfully advance the modern university, producing (1) an atmosphere that develops new products and innovations helping society to expand and grow; (2) a workforce that can help any enterprise maintain an entrepreneurial posture; and (3) a climate conducive to high achievers that create the innovations of tomorrow (Kuratko 2005).

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